Nathalie El-Bazzal

PhD Candidate in Economics, University of Paris 8
Research Affiliate, Paris School of Economics

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Research Interests

International Trade · Geoeconomics · Political Economy · Global Value Chains

Education

2026-Present **PhD in Economics**, University of Paris 8, France
Thesis: *Trade Shocks and Geoeconomic Fragmentation*
Supervisor: Prof. Jamel Saadaoui

2024-2026 **Pre-Doctoral Studies in Economics**, University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, France
Highest Honors (GPA: 4.0/4.0)
Coursework: Econometrics; International Trade; Applied Quantitative Methods; Firm Competitiveness; Trade and Finance

2020-2021 **MSc in Financial Management**, ESCP Business School, France
Thesis: *Foreign Direct Investment in a Conflict Country: The Syrian Case*

2018-2020 **MA in International Relations**, Sciences Po Grenoble, France
Middle Eastern and Mediterranean Studies
Thesis: *Economic Recovery in Syria under Political Instability*

2014-2018 **BA in Political Science**, University of Lille, France
Third year at Saint Joseph University of Beirut, Lebanon (2017-2018)

Research

Working Paper

Chokepoint Risk and Trade: Evidence from the Red Sea Crisis
Single-authored · *Best Graduate Student Paper Award, SETC-FREIT 2026*

Work in Progress

Geoeconomic Fragmentation and Market Integration during the Syrian Conflict
with Pierre-Louis Vézina (King's College London) · *Accepted at the ReCIPE Annual Conference 2027, Oxford*

Measuring Bilateral Geopolitical Tensions
with Jean-Charles Bricongne (Banque de France), Benoît Chaulvet (Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne), Thomas Renault (Paris-Saclay), and Jamel Saadaoui (Paris 8)

Research Notes

When Market Spillovers Are Not Geopolitics (2026)
with Jamel Saadaoui (Paris 8)

Grants and Awards

2026-2028 **CEPR ReCIPE Big Research Grant** (£100,000)
Trade and Financial Frictions in Fragmented Economies
Co-Principal Investigator with Pierre-Louis Vézina (King's College London) and Jean-Charles Bricongne (Banque de France).
I initiated, conceptualized, and led the proposal.

2026 **Best Graduate Student Paper Award**, SETC-FREIT
Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference, for *Chokepoint Risk and Trade: Evidence from the Red Sea Crisis*

Presentations

2027 ReCIPE Annual Conference, Oxford (scheduled, March)

2026 Geopolitical Alignment, Tensions, and the Global Economy, Paris Nanterre (scheduled, December); Kiel-CEPR Conference on Geoeconomics (Junior Poster Session), Berlin; Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC-FREIT), Alghero; European Trade Study Group (ETSG), Exeter; Economic Data Science Society Inaugural Conference (poster), Banque de France, Paris; World Trade Dialogue, Hamburg

Discussions

2026 *Russia's Wartime Economy: Measuring Regional Inequalities from Outer Space*, by J. Fidrmuc, I. Barbakadze, M. Hulényi, and K. Kapanadze
Geopolitical Alignment, Tensions, and the Global Economy (scheduled, December)

2026 *Evading Sanctions*, by F. A. Teti, L. Scheckenhofer, D. Torun, and J. Wanner
Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC-FREIT)

2026 *Geopolitical Risk and Foreign Dependence in Global Shipping*, by S. Fuchs, F. Leibovici, and W. F. Wong
World Trade Dialogue

Workshops

2027 ReCIPE-PEDL Workshop (CEPR), Oxford (scheduled, March)

Teaching

University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne

Fall 2026 **Introduction to Geopolitics**, Module Leader (Collège de Management, third-year undergraduate)
Designed the full module: syllabus, curriculum, lectures, and teaching materials.

Spring 2026 **Introduction to Econometrics**, Teaching Assistant (Economics, undergraduate)

Fall 2025 **History of Economic Thought**, Teaching Assistant (Economics, undergraduate)

IRIS Sup' - Institute for International and Strategic Affairs

2023-Present **Master's Thesis Supervisor and Project Leader**
- Supervise Master's theses in geopolitics, international trade, and development.
- Supervise group reports on public-private partnerships, economic diversification, labor markets, and geopolitical disruptions.

Research Experience

2026-Present **Junior Researcher**, Paris School of Economics
- Research on international trade, geoeconomics, and geopolitical fragmentation.
- Scientific coordination and day-to-day management of the CEPR ReCIPE project.

Professional Experience

2022-2024 **Trade Advisor, Industry and Cleantech**, Business France - French Embassy. Cairo, Egypt
- Sectoral economic analyses across energy, infrastructure, transport, water, waste management, and security.
- Advised more than 160 firms on market-entry strategies and international expansion across MENA.
- Organized high-level trade missions across Egypt, Jordan, Tunisia, and the UAE.

Nov 2021-Jan 2022 — **Digital Transformation Analyst**, Safran. Paris, France
- Quantitative analysis of digital-transformation strategies and organizational performance.
- Synthesized academic literature to support strategic decision-making.

Sep 2021-Feb 2022 — **Research Assistant and Project Coordinator**, ESCP Business School. Paris, France
- Coordinated research projects within the Corporate Governance and Retailing Chairs.
- Applied research on foreign-direct-investment screening and retail transformation.

2019-2020 — **Chief Education Advisor**, French High School Charles de Gaulle. Damascus, Syria
- Managed academic operations and implemented educational policies in a complex geopolitical environment.

Sep 2018-Mar 2019 — **Trade Officer**, Business France - French Embassy. Doha, Qatar
- Economic and sectoral analyses of Qatari industries.
- Organized the Qatar-France Business and Investment Forum.

Other Activities

2023-Present — **Delegate**, ESCP Alumni MENA

2016-2020 — **Founder**, Public Speaking Club (workshops in France, Lebanon, and Qatar)

Jul-Aug 2018 — **Journalism Intern**, *Aujourd'hui la Turquie*. Istanbul, Turkey

2014-2015 — **Former High-Level Athlete, Wrestling**
Silver medal, French National Championships (2015); bronze medal (2014); international medalist.

Skills

Software — R, Python, Stata, LaTeX

Languages — French and Arabic (native), English (fluent)